

Digital Accessibility

Screen readers are essential assistive technologies that help people with visual impairments access digital content independently. They convert on-screen text into synthesized speech or refreshable braille output, enabling users to read documents, browse websites, and use applications effectively. Popular screen readers include JAWS, NVDA, VoiceOver, Window-Eyes, and System Access. These tools support navigation through headings, links, tables, and form controls. By improving access to information, screen readers play a vital role in creating an inclusive digital experience.

Usage Trends and Adoption

Screen reader usage data highlights the growing importance of accessible technology. JAWS remains the most widely used screen reader, accounting for nearly half of all reported usage. NVDA has experienced significant growth due to its free and open-source availability, while VoiceOver continues to serve Apple device users. The comparison between 2010 and 2012 shows increasing adoption of alternative screen reader solutions. These trends reflect greater awareness of accessibility needs and the continuing evolution of assistive technologies across different platforms.

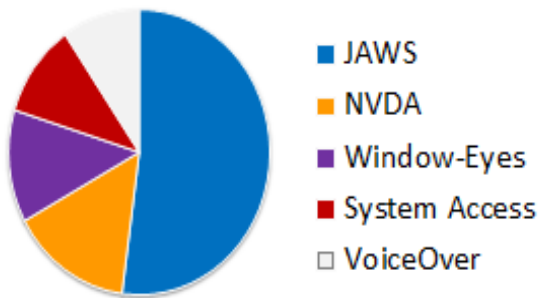


Web Access



The text in the image explains the importance of **alternative text (Alt Text)** for images. Alt Text helps screen readers describe images to visually impaired users, improving document accessibility.

The graphic on the left is a **Web Accessibility Symbol**, represented by a globe with a keyhole. It symbolizes secure and accessible access to web-based information and resources.



The pie chart shows the usage distribution of different screen reader applications. **JAWS** represents the largest share, indicating the highest level of usage among users. **NVDA, Window-Eyes, System Access, and VoiceOver** account for smaller portions of the chart. Charts help present data visually, making comparisons and trends easier to understand.

Screen Reader Statistics

This table presents the number of responses and percentage share for different screen reader applications used by users.

Screen Reader	Responses	Share
JAWS	853	49%
NVDA	238	14%
Window-Eyes	214	12%
System Access	181	10%
VoiceOver	159	9%

Screen Reader Usage Data

This table compares the responses and percentage share of various screen reader applications between September 2010 and May 2012.

	May 2012		September 2010	
Screen Reader	Responses	Share	Responses	Share
JAWS	853	49%	727	59%
NVDA	238	14%	105	9%
Window-Eyes	214	12%	138	11%
System Access	181	10%	58	5%
VoiceOver	159	9%	120	10%

Accessibility Tools

Screen readers are assistive technologies designed to help people access digital content. They convert on-screen text into speech or braille output. Screen readers enable users to navigate documents, websites, and applications independently.

Popular screen readers include JAWS, NVDA, Window-Eyes, System Access, and VoiceOver. These tools read text, headings, links, tables, and form controls aloud. They help improve accessibility for users with visual impairments.